

Alwar's numerous palaces and forts, lakes, hunting lodges, archaeological sites and thick forests, make for a delightful setting.

Bundi Festival

11-13 November, 2022/Bundi

The Bundi Festival is celebrated in the month of Kartik (October-November) and includes several spiritual and traditional activities. It is a remarkable cluster of traditional culture and craftsmanship and visitors are left charmed by its magnificence. The programme includes a colourful Shobha Yatra, arts & crafts fair, ethnic sports, cultural exhibition, classical music & dance programme, turban competitions, etc. Early in the morning, after a full moon night, women and men clad in colourful costumes light diyas on the banks of the Chambal River and seek blessings.

Kumbhalgarh Festival

1-3 December, 2022/Rajsamand

The Kumbhalgarh Fort, cradled in the Aravalis north of Udaipur, hosts this vibrant and colourful three-day festival. In the daytime there are folk performances by traditional artistes and competitions like turban tying and henna applying. The night, on the other hand, is filled with impressive explosions of lights, sound, colours and classical dance.

Winter Festival

29-30 December, 2022/Mount Abu

The annual Winter Festival at Mount Abu pays homage to the rich culture and tradition of Rajasthan. The much-talked about event is a rare combination of cultural vibrancy, stunning handicrafts and delicious food, set against a scenic backdrop. The two-day extravaganza brings together craftsmen and performers from across the state. It is also known for its sporting and entertainment events. A grand procession marks the beginning, and the festival culminates at the Nakki Lake with hundreds of diyas set afloat in the water.

Camel Festival

14-15 January, 2023/Bikaner

Bikaner's two-day Camel Festival is a celebration of the 'Ship of the Desert'. Held in January each year, the festival starts with a colourful parade of graciously adorned camels against the backdrop of the Junagarh Fort. The camels come decked in all their finery, from bridles to necklaces and anklets. There are camel races, camel games as well as cultural performances.

Desert Festival

3-5 February, 2023/Jaisalmer

Once a year, the empty sands around Jaisalmer come alive with a mesmerising performance on the sand dunes in the form of the Desert Festival. Organised by the Department of Tourism, the three-day festival allows you to enjoy Rajasthani folk culture to the fullest. Rajasthani men and women dressed in their best and brightest costumes dance and sing ballads, while traditional musicians attempt to outdo each other. There are a host of other activities and competitions to keep the excitement up.

Braj Holi Festival

1-2 March, 2023/Bharatpur

The Braj festival in Rajasthan is held every year for two days in the Shukla Paksha of the Phalgun month, a few days prior to Holi. This festival is dedicated to Lord Krishna who is believed to have spent a considerable amount of time in a region called Braj in Rajasthan. This festival not only replicates the spirit of Holi but also impersonates the timeless love of Radha and Krishna. The highlight is the Raslila dance performed with great zest. The entire town is painted and no one is spared from being splashed with colours.

Gangaur

24-25 March, 2023/Jaipur

Gangaur is one of the most important festivals in Rajasthan. “Gan” is a synonym for Lord Shiva & “Gauri” or “Gaur” stands for Goddess Parvati, the heavenly consort of Lord Shiva. Gangaur celebrates the union of the two and is a symbol of conjugal & marital happiness. It is celebrated in the month of Chaitra (March-April). This festival is celebrated especially by women, who worship clay idols of “Gan” & “Gauri” in their homes. On the eve of the Gangaur festival, women decorate their palms and fingers with henna. The idols of Gan and Gauri are immersed in a pond or nearby lake on the last day. A traditional procession of Gangaur wends its way through the city.

Mewar Festival

24-26 March, 2023/Udaipur

To experience the colour and joy that fills the people of Rajasthan, visiting Udaipur during the Mewar Festival is a must. The festival celebrates the arrival of spring. Local markets and shops decorate their façades with bright lights and decorations. Coinciding with Gangaur, the Mewar Festival is equally significant for the womenfolk of Rajasthan. Women dress images of Lord Shiva and Goddess Parvati and carry them in a procession through the city, finally immersing them in the middle of Pichola Lake.

PUSHKAR FAIR

1-8 November, 2022/Ajmer

The Pushkar Fair (Pushkar Cattle Fair) or Pushkar Mela is an annual weeklong camel and livestock fair held in the town of Pushkar between the months of October and November. It is one of the world's largest camel fairs and a popular tourist attraction. Competitions such as the ‘matka phod’, ‘longest moustache’ and ‘bridal competition’ are some of draws.



